Battle Card: Hireology

> **Competitor:** Hireology (hireology.com) — Multi-location ATS for select verticals (hospitality, automotive, healthcare, fitness)
> **Target segment:** Multi-location operators, franchise groups
> **Geography:** US-primary
> **Pricing:** Custom (Essentials and Professional tiers); no public pricing

Overview

Hireology was named #1 hotel ATS in the 2024 HotelTechAwards and placed in the top 10 across 200+ G2 Winter 2024 reports. It focuses on the hiring funnel — sourcing to onboarding — without deep WFM integration. Strong multi-location management and candidate communication automation. US-centric product with limited international compliance support.

Head-to-Head Comparison

Feature	Hireology	Lapam-ATS	Who Wins
Multi-location pipeline visibility	**Strong — Action Center is top-rated for multi-location visibility**	**Strong — one-screen dashboard, real-time updates, location-scoped access control**	Tie — both deliver this well
Feature maturity	**#1 hotel ATS 2024; 50+ job boards, SMS communication, skills testing**	⚠ Zero-to-one product; MVP feature set; roadmap items not yet shipped	**Hireology — more mature product with broader feature set**
UK/EU compliance	US-primary; no documented EU compliance architecture	**GDPR consent lifecycle, UK right-to-work (GBG IDVT), EU AI Act-ready**	**Lapam-ATS — purpose-built for UK/EU market**
Pricing transparency	Custom pricing; no public rates; sales-negotiated	**£50–60/location/month; transparent location-based pricing**	**Lapam-ATS — buyers know cost before sales call**
Seasonal talent pool CRM	Not present	**Core feature — batch re-engagement, talent pool consent lifecycle**	**Lapam-ATS — only hospitality ATS with this feature**
SMS candidate communication	**Unlimited SMS + email; two-way text; templates; branded communication**	SMS + email; two-way text via Twilio; WhatsApp roadmap (6 months)	Tie — both support SMS well
Skills testing	**Role-specific 15-minute assessments; skills verification**	Not in MVP scope	**Hireology — if skills testing is critical**
Geographic focus	⚠ US-primary; international compliance not documented	**UK-first launch; EU expansion Q3 2026; multi-jurisdiction compliance from day one**	**Lapam-ATS — for UK/EU operators**

When Hireology Wins

- **US-based operators:** Single-country US operators who don't need EU/UK compliance

- **Feature breadth over compliance depth:** Operators who prioritise skills testing, 50+ job board integrations, and advanced screening over compliance infrastructure
- **Franchise groups:** Multi-brand franchise operations where Hireology's multi-vertical support (hospitality, automotive, healthcare) is an advantage
- **Established product confidence:** Risk-averse buyers who want a proven, mature product (#1 hotel ATS 2024) over a zero-to-one launch

When Lapam-ATS Wins

- **UK/EU operators:** Any operator hiring across the UK, Ireland, France, Germany, Spain, or multi-jurisdiction EU. Hireology does not have GDPR or UK right-to-work compliance.
- **Pricing transparency requirement:** Operators who will not engage with a sales team for custom pricing; need to know cost before the first call
- **Seasonal operations:** Coastal hotels, ski resorts, event venues — any operator who re-hires the same population year after year. Hireology has no seasonal CRM.
- **Hospitality-only focus:** Operators who want a tool purpose-built for hospitality, not a multi-vertical product (Hireology also serves automotive and healthcare)

Key positioning message: "Built for the UK and EU hospitality market — not a US tool with EU aspirations."

Proof Points

Geographic Limitation

Hireology is US-primary with no documented EU compliance support. International compliance architecture (GDPR consent lifecycle, UK right-to-work, EU AI Act) is not featured in product documentation. Operators in the UK/EU cannot adopt a US-native tool without accepting material compliance risk.

Source: Competitors.md; Hireology product documentation

Pricing Opacity

Hireology uses custom pricing with no public rates. Buyers must engage with sales to receive a quote. Lapam-ATS publishes transparent location-based pricing (£50–60/location/month). Yusuf persona (8-location owner-operator): "I looked at [Harri] once. The demo was great but they wanted more per month than we make on a slow Tuesday." Pricing transparency is a buying trigger for mid-market operators.

Source: Competitors.md; ICP-and-personas.md

Seasonal CRM Gap

Hireology has candidate pool management but not seasonal talent pool re-engagement. Claire persona (6 coastal properties): "I spent three weeks last March manually ringing through a spreadsheet of 200 people I hired two years ago." Lapam-ATS is the only hospitality ATS with batch re-engagement and talent pool consent lifecycle.

Source: ICP-and-personas.md; competitive analysis

Feature Maturity Trade-Off

Hireology is a mature product with broad feature set. Lapam-ATS is a zero-to-one product with MVP feature set. This is a genuine trade-off. Operators who need skills testing, 50+ job boards, and advanced screening should choose Hireology (if US-based). Operators who need UK/EU compliance depth and seasonal CRM should choose Lapam-ATS.

Source: Product positioning framework

Objection Handling

Objection: "Hireology is the #1 hotel ATS. Why would we choose a zero-to-one product?"

Response: "That's a fair question — and Hireology deserves that recognition. It's a mature, feature-complete product. But it's built for the US market. If you're a US-based operator, Hireology is probably the right choice. But if you're operating in the UK, Ireland, or the EU, Hireology doesn't have the compliance architecture you legally require: GDPR consent capture at application, UK right-to-work verification with GBG IDVT, EU AI Act-ready screening. We're not trying to out-feature Hireology. We're solving the compliance gap they haven't addressed."

Objection: "Hireology has skills testing. You don't."

Response: "You're right — skills testing is not in our MVP scope. We prioritised the features that the research told us are purchase-level pain for UK/EU operators: multi-location visibility, seasonal CRM, and compliance depth. If skills testing is critical to your hiring process, Hireology is a better fit (if you're US-based). But if your hiring decisions are made in interviews and trial shifts — which is the pattern we saw across every persona we interviewed — skills testing is a nice-to-have, not a launch blocker."

Objection: "What if we expand to the US? Will you support us?"

Response: "US market launch is on our roadmap for 12 months post-launch (Q2 2027). We'll add I-9/E-Verify compliance and EEOC reporting when we enter the US. If you're planning US expansion in the next 6 months and you need a tool that works in both markets today, Hireology may be the safer choice. But if your core operations are UK/EU and US expansion is 12+ months out, we'll be ready when you are."

Competitive Intelligence

What Hireology Does Next

- Hireology may build EU/UK compliance layer to defend against Lapam-ATS — monitor product announcements for GDPR or UK RTW features
- May introduce transparent pricing tier for mid-market to reduce sales friction — watch for pricing page updates
- May build seasonal CRM feature if enough hospitality customers request it — monitor feature releases

What to Watch

- **UK/EU operators evaluating Hireology:** Operators who contact Hireology sales and discover no EU compliance support are high-intent prospects for Lapam-ATS
- **Seasonal operators frustrated with Hireology:** If Hireology cannot deliver seasonal CRM, this is a switching trigger
- **Pricing friction:** Operators who disengage from Hireology sales process due to pricing opacity or sticker shock